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Hackathon: Bonding x itestra

May 29–31, 2026



What is it about?

Snake Reloaded!



How does it work?

Bot Tournament

- You program bots for the game Snake
- Your bots compete against each other in tournaments
- In addition to the classic Snake, there will be various items available later

Test servers offer various games

- We host various servers
- You can connect to the IPs
- The servers offer a UI where you can view the ongoing games and also reset them
- You also have the option to host servers yourself

The Game

Objective

- Collect points in the tournaments
- The team with the most points at the end wins

Tournament

- In each tournament, all teams compete in a match with 4 lines
- The winning teams (longest line) play a match against each other

The Game

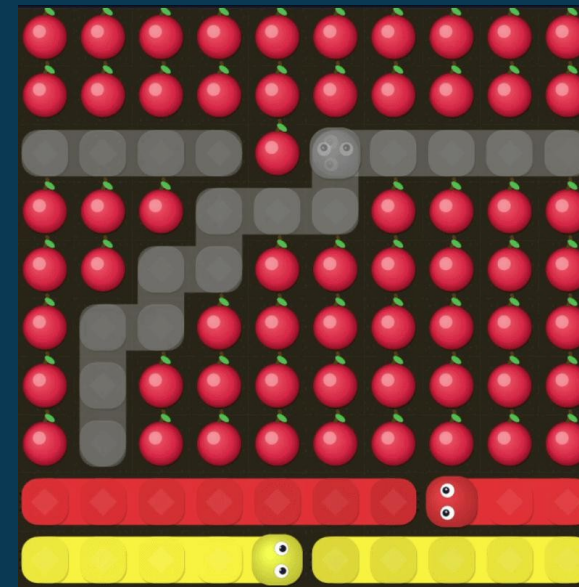
End of the game:

If one of the following scenarios occurs, the game ends immediately:

- No snakes are left
- Exactly one snake is still alive
- If the game stalls (e.g., two snakes are running in circles, etc.)

Scoring

- The base points per round correspond to the length of your snake at the end of a game
- The snake with the most points wins
- The snake that survives the longest gets a bonus, but does not automatically win
- Later games award extra points
 - Grand Finale (Sunday 10:00)



How do you play the game?

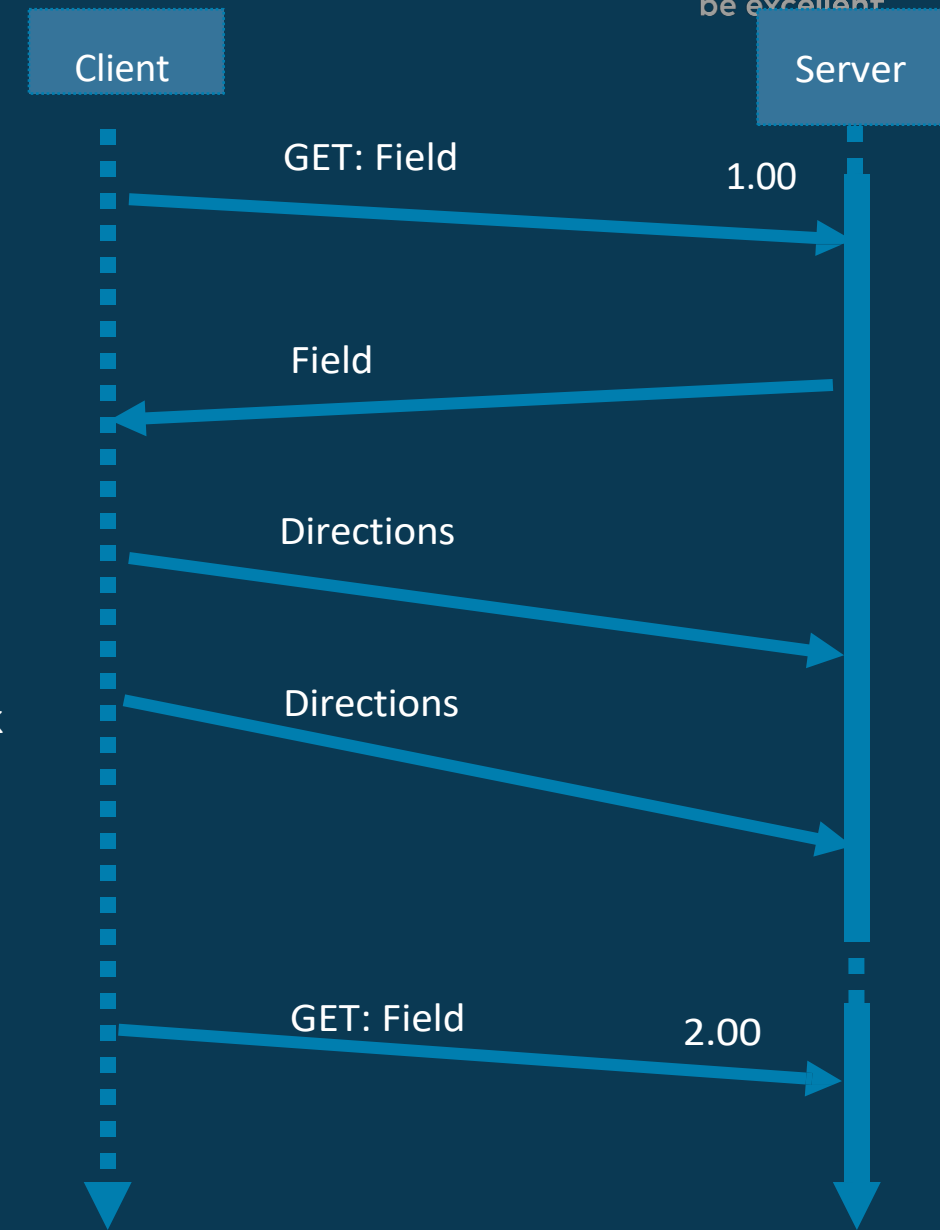
Server

- The game server ticks once per second* at fixed intervals
- The game field is updated per tick
- The current game field can be requested from the server

Clients

- You query the game board once per tick
- You calculate your next move
- You post the direction in which your snake should move in the next tick north, west, south, or east
 - North, West, South, East
- Only the last post is considered for the next tick

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Game Tick in Detail 1/2

Reading the direction

- For each snake, the most recently posted direction is evaluated

Movement Phase

- All snakes move one space simultaneously in the set direction
- The snake can leave the playing field in any direction; it re-enters at the opposite edge

Collisions

- If a snake's head touches any object:
 - The snake dies
- All collisions are handled simultaneously

Game Tick in Detail 2/2

Collecting Items

- Any item touched by a snake's head is collected
- Apples cause the snake to grow one space immediately
 - The last tile of the snake is duplicated

New items spawn

- After all the snake's actions have been processed, new items spawn
- Items spawn randomly, but not on already occupied spaces.

Implementation

Provided clients

- Minimal frameworks in Java and Python
- You can find the clients in Nextcloud
- Feel free to use any language you want!

Debugging and Testing

- Test your implementation against other teams on the test servers
- Test against your local servers
- You can create your own test scenarios

Use of AI

- Feel free to use any form of AI support available to you
- Warning! Your code must be adaptable to changes in the game at all times!

Authentication

Local test server

- The password is always "test"

Global Test Servers and Tournaments

- You provide us with your team name
- We will assign you a password
- You can connect to the servers using your team name and password

Saturday Schedule

Welcome and introduction

9:00

Tournament

5:00 PM

Tournament

10:15

Tournament

7:00 PM

Tournament

11:00

Group dinner

7:15

Tournament

1:00 PM

Tournament

10:00
PM

Tournament

3:00

Tournament

12:00
a.m.

First two matches
< 45 minutes!

Longer
Break

Sunday Schedule



Tournament	2:00	Awards Ceremony	12:00
Tournament	4:00		
Tournament	6:00		
Tournament	8:00		
Tournament	10:00		